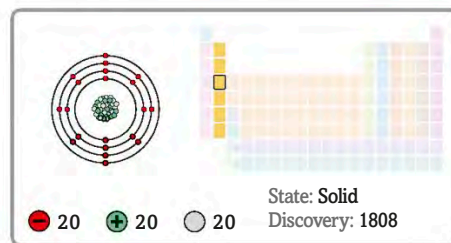


20
Ca

Calcium



Forms



This crystal has a shiny surface.

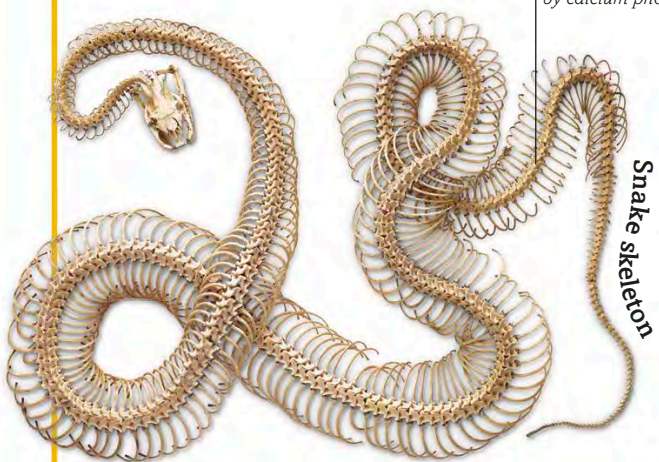
Calcite

Large, fang-like crystals



Aragonite

These column-shaped crystals contain calcium carbonate.



Bones are hardened by calcium phosphate.

Snake skeleton



This pure metal is soft enough to cut with a knife.

Crystals of pure calcium refined in a laboratory

The most abundant metal in the human body, calcium is also the fifth most common element on Earth. It appears in many minerals: **calcite** and **aragonite** are made of a compound of calcium and carbon called calcium carbonate. Bones in animal **skeletons**

contain the compound calcium phosphate. The hard, outer layers of many other animals, such as the **shells** of sea snails, are made of calcium carbonate. Calcium is very important in our diet. We get calcium by eating **calcium-rich food**, including dairy products, green